

from the grounds up -- Blackberry 10 or BB 10. The brand new BB 10 OS is re-imagined for touch input without compromising on Blackberry's traditional keypad experience. What's more, the OS can run Android apps on it through a runtime layer. For Blackberry users who haven't used it, the OS is a breath of fresh air. With Blackberry claiming the presence of over 1,20,000 third-party apps on its app store, seems like the BB platform is poised to challenge the likes of Windows and eventually iOS and Android for a piece of the mobile market. If you're a Blackberry fan disappointed with the company (in the last year or so), and considering a switch to iOS or Android, don't give up just yet. You'll notice that with the latest incarnation of BB 10, the OS is comparable to Android or iOS in terms of features and options.

Decide what hardware you'll need

Now that you have some idea about the major platforms that are up for grabs while considering to buy a new smart, portable device (be it a laptop, smartphone, tablet or hybrid device), let's now get into determining how to choose between different hardware configurations found on most of these devices.

Laptops & Hybrids

As far as laptops and ultrabooks are concerned, also tablet-ultrabook hybrids based on x86 platform, there continues to be an abundance of Intel-based machines launched by OEMs, and the number of AMD-based notebooks remains low. As you may know, Intel officially unveiled Haswell last month, its fourth generation of Core processors based on a new 22nm fabrication process which promises to deliver better performance (especially onboard graphics) and better power efficiency than ever before. If you're looking at purchasing a laptop or ultrabook with the latest and greatest hardware then you simply can't miss out on the new Intel "Haswell" enabled ultrabooks which should start selling in the Indian market very soon. AMD APUs in the past haven't matched up to Intel's sheer processing speed, as per our experience, and we don't expect it to make any significant inroads this year as well. So if it's speed and processing prowess you're after on your ultrabook or notebook, Intel is still the way to go.

However, historically, AMD's lower-end APUs do offer slightly better graphics than Intel's onboard chips -- especially in the 10 or 11-inch